

Phase 5 would not be needed if there were a perfect one-to-one mapping between graphemes and phonemes. English is unlike most other languages. Many of the mappings are one-to-several in both directions: that is to say, most phonemes can be spelled in more than one way, and most graphemes can represent more than one phoneme.

Children entering Phase 5 are able to read and spell words containing adjacent consonants and some polysyllabic words. They should have at least one grapheme representation for each of the 44 sounds.

The purpose of this phase is for children to broaden their knowledge of graphemes and phonemes for use in reading and spelling. They will learn new graphemes and alternative pronunciations for these and graphemes they already know, where relevant. Some of the alternatives will already have been encountered in the High Frequency Words that have been taught. Children will become quicker at recognising graphemes of more than one letter in words and at blending the phonemes they represent. When spelling words they will learn to choose the appropriate graphemes to represent phonemes and begin to build word-specific knowledge of the spelling of words.

Phase 5 is taught over 6 weeks and new alternative vowel sounds are introduced according to the progression. Again, decodable readers are grouped according to graphemes introduced during the week, and may be more effective when introduced a week behind the progression. Common Exception Words (CEWs) are also introduced according to the progression. Weeks 5 - 6 cover split digraphs, whilst Week 7 is used for revision and consolidation.

Letter Progression

Phase 5 – Vowel Sounds

ay	ou	ie	ea	oy	ir	ue	aw
wh	ph	ew	oe	au	ey	a-e	e-e
i-e	o-e	u-e					